

OP3 Internal Mobility Fair

Pillar	Opportunity	Difficulty	Level 1
Time Required	60-90 minutes (event format)	Group Size	10-50+ (cross-departmental)
Mode	Organisational event (manager coordinates, multiple departments participate)	Format	In-person preferred; virtual adaptation below
Prerequisites	None	CLOVER ERA Trigger	Lack of internal mobility, employees unaware of roles in other departments, silos between teams, retention risk from employees not seeing growth paths

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

Novelty activates dopamine. Exposure to new roles, teams, and work types triggers the brain's exploratory systems in a way that routine work does not. The Internal Mobility Fair is essentially a structured novelty experience: it shows employees that their organisation contains possibilities they hadn't considered.

The brain's career planning circuitry (prefrontal cortex) needs concrete information to build plans. Abstract knowledge that 'other departments exist' does not activate planning. Meeting a real person from that department who describes their actual work does. The fair converts abstract awareness into concrete possibility.

The Exercise

Phase 1: Preparation (1-2 weeks before)

Coordinate with 4-6 departments. Each department prepares:

- A 3-minute overview of what their team actually does (not the job description, the reality)
- 2-3 specific opportunities available to people from other teams (projects, shadows, rotations)
- One person who genuinely enjoys talking about their work and can answer questions honestly

FACILITATION NOTE

The quality of the fair depends entirely on who represents each department. Choose people who are enthusiastic and honest, not necessarily the most senior. An engaged individual contributor who can describe their day-to-day vividly is more valuable than a department head reading from a slide deck.

Phase 2: The Fair (60-90 minutes)

Format: rotating conversations, not presentations. Each attendee spends 10-12 minutes with each department. The department representative talks for 3 minutes, then answers questions for 7-9 minutes.

Provide each attendee with an Interest Card:

- Departments that surprised me:
- One opportunity I want to explore further:
- One person I want to follow up with:

Phase 3: Follow-Up (within 1 week)

The manager reviews each team member's Interest Card in their next 1:1. For each interest identified, agree on a concrete next step: an informational conversation, a shadow day, or a formal expression of interest.

WHAT TO SAY

"What caught your attention at the fair? Let's figure out whether it's worth exploring further and what the first step would be."

Remote/Virtual Adaptation

Run as a series of 30-minute virtual "open house" sessions over a week, one per department. Employees drop into the sessions they're interested in. Use breakout rooms for small-group Q&A. The Interest Card becomes a digital form submitted after each session.

Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
OP1: Ambition Roadmap	The fair surfaces options that feed into OP1's aspiration mapping.	Run the fair before or alongside OP1
OP4: Mentorship	Cross-departmental connections from the fair can become mentoring relationships.	Fair connections feed into OP4
OP6: Career Path	The fair is a living demonstration of career path transparency.	Complementary

Transparency		
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